WOLFE

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MINI GUIDE

REJECTION & RESILIENCE

How to take a "no" or silence without losing your confidence, and keep going.

INSIDE

CONTENTS

- What rejection is, and is not
- The first 24 hours
- Reframe the thought
- Graceful replies
- When she goes quiet (ghosting)
- When it keeps happening
- A self-compassion exercise
- My rejection log
- When to get support

Dorian Wolfe shares general communication advice for adults. It is not therapy and no result is guaranteed. Always respect other people's boundaries and consent.

INTRODUCTION

WHAT REJECTION IS, AND IS NOT

Rejection hurts. It is part of dating for everyone, whatever their age or looks. How you respond shapes your confidence far more than the rejection itself.

It is information about fit	It says what she wants right now. It does not say what you are worth.
You usually cannot know why	Timing, chemistry, her own situation. Do not invent a reason.
People like you more than you think	Research on the "liking gap" finds people underestimate how much others liked them after a conversation.

CHAPTER 1

THE FIRST 24 HOURS

1. Pause	Do not reply in anger or send long messages.
2. Name the feeling	"I feel disappointed." Naming it lowers its grip.
3. Move	A walk, gym, a run. Movement helps.
4. Talk to someone	A friend. Not to fix it, just to say it.
5. Write it down	What happened, what you felt, what you can learn.
6. Do something you enjoy	Cook, call a friend, watch something good.

DO NOT

Do not send insults, repeated messages or ask "why" again and again. It does not help you, and it can cross into harassment.

CHAPTER 2

REFRAME THE THOUGHT

"I am not good enough."	"We were not a match. That is all this tells me."
"I am too old."	"Some people will not be interested. Others will."
"I will never find anyone."	"I have had one no. One no does not predict the future."
"I should give up."	"I can take a break, then try again with what I learned."

TRY THIS

Write your own harsh thought on a page. Next to it, write what you would say to a friend in the same position.

CHAPTER 3

GRACEFUL REPLIES

> **Thanks for telling me. I appreciate the honesty. Take care.**

> **No hard feelings at all. It was good to meet you.**

> **All good, I enjoyed chatting. Best of luck.**

A kind exit builds respect, even from someone who said no.

CHAPTER 4

WHEN SHE GOES QUIET (GHOSTING)

Wait two days	Do not send follow-ups.
Send one light message	"Hey, hope your week is going well. Still up for that coffee?"
Then let it go	Silence is an answer. You can stay kind and move on.

For more, see the "She Went Quiet" guide.

CHAPTER 5

WHEN IT KEEPS HAPPENING

A run of no's is discouraging. Look at it calmly:

- [ ] Are my photos clear, recent and smiling?
- [ ] Are my messages specific and easy to answer?
- [ ] Am I contacting people who match what I want?
- [ ] Am I moving to a coffee after a few good messages?
- [ ] Do I need a break to recharge?

Change one thing at a time. Ask a trusted friend to look at your profile.

CHAPTER 6

A SELF-COMPASSION EXERCISE

1. Notice	"This is a painful moment."
2. Remember others	"Rejection happens to everyone. I am not alone."
3. Be kind	"May I be kind to myself. What do I need right now?"

Research suggests self-compassion helps people recover from setbacks better than harsh self-criticism does.

WORKSHEET

MY REJECTION LOG

WHAT HAPPENED

WHAT I FELT

WHAT I TELL MYSELF

WHAT I WOULD SAY TO A FRIEND

ONE THING I WILL DO NEXT

HELP

WHEN TO GET SUPPORT

If rejection leaves you feeling hopeless, avoiding people for weeks, or thinking of harming yourself, please reach out.

IF IT FEELS HEAVIER THAN NERVES

If you feel hopeless, or think about harming yourself, please talk to someone now. In the US, call or text 988. In the UK, Samaritans: 116 123. Elsewhere, findahelpline.com lists local services.

A therapist, especially one who uses CBT, can help with confidence and low mood.

A NOTE ON EVIDENCE

This guide uses general relationship and social-skills research plus common sense. Studies of men over 40 are limited, so treat everything here as practical guidance, not a guarantee. It is not therapy, medical advice, legal advice or financial advice.

BE CALM.

BE CURIOUS.

BE REAL.

— Dorian Wolfe